

THE LAYOVER

NCCA
ENTERTAINMENT

When an ice storm seals five strangers inside an Atlanta airport's underground service bay (a federal witness, the marshal hiding the truth about her, a mother racing the clock to her daughter's wedding, and two women who didn't end up there by accident), a rising carbon monoxide leak forces all five to find out who's lying before the air runs out.

LOGLINE

GENRE

Contained thriller / ensemble drama

FORMAT

Feature film. Single location, real time

SETTING

Hartsfield-Jackson Atlanta International Airport, one storm night

PAGE COUNT

Approx. 80 pages (80 to 85 target)

PRIMARY CAST

5 women leads, ages 29 to 64, majority-Black ensemble

PREPARED FOR

TV One (lead) and BET+ (co-lead)

SYNOPSIS

Court reporter Patricia Brown just wants to find her daughter's wedding dress before an ice storm shuts down Hartsfield-Jackson. Instead, a security grate seals her into an underground service bay with four strangers: Diana, the deputy marshal quietly responsible for putting them all in danger; Monique, the federal witness Diana is moving under false paperwork; Simone, who took a contract to kill Monique for reasons that have nothing to do with money; and Kendra, a crisis counselor whose calm is the most dangerous thing in the room.

As the storm knocks out power and a carbon monoxide leak starts climbing, the five women are forced into an uneasy, shifting alliance, trading truths they came in planning to take to their graves. What surfaces is a story about a dead sister, a stolen fortune, a little girl in foster care, and a hired killer working an agenda none of the others can see coming. Getting out alive means figuring out which of the women beside you is the reason you're trapped. Patricia has thirty-one years of reading liars for a living standing between all of them and the truth.

THEMES

- What a mother will trade to protect a child: money, silence, the truth, herself.
- The cost of self-protection versus the cost of honesty, examined through five women's choices in the same room.
- Found family and reckoning: enemies forced into becoming each other's only chance of survival.

WHY TV ONE AND BET+

TV One has built its audience on contained, relationship-driven danger: accessible stakes, a legible emotional problem, a small principal cast. **THE LAYOVER** leads with exactly that. A mother racing to her daughter's wedding grounds the thriller mechanics in a stake every viewer feels before the gas leak and the hidden killer ever enter the room.

BET+ has built its slate on premium ensembles led by culturally specific, castable Black characters, not a genre plot with Black faces dropped in. Five distinct women, each with a contradiction and a secret worth a scene, own this story from the opening minute, anchored by a commanding 64-year-old protagonist, a lead role rarely written at that age. The genre engine gets the meeting. The ensemble gets the greenlight.

COMPARABLE TITLES

A contained, relationship-driven thriller in the tradition of TV One's signature movie brand, threaded with the premium, culturally specific ensemble work of BET+ titles like **The Family Business**, **The Black Hamptons** and **First Wives Club**.

PLATFORM FIT

TV One

Primary fit. A legible emotional problem (a mother racing to her daughter's wedding) leads. Thriller mechanics never outrun the human story: one main set, a small principal cast, a clock producers can plan around.

BET+

Co-lead fit. Five culturally specific Black women each own a piece of the story, with the contradiction and quotable dialogue that attract recognizable talent. Genre engine underneath, character engine on top.

Alt lane if needed: Tubi, Lifetime and ALLBLK (Monique and Simone's emotional spine, not the conspiracy architecture).

NCCA Entertainment. Atlanta, GA. Kelly R. Tenney, Founder.

CAST SUGGESTIONS

Illustrative packaging wish list, organized by role, calibrated to TV One and BET+ casting lanes. Names reflect type, age range and performance register. None are attached or confirmed.

PATRICIA BROWN

64 • Lead • Atlanta court reporter, mother of the bride

A commanding, still center who reads a room for a living and spends the film learning what her own instincts have been protecting her from. Needs an actress who can hold quiet dominance for eighty pages and still find the crack in Act Three.

SUGGESTED: Angela Bassett • Sheryl Lee Ralph • Vivica A. Fox

DIANA COLE

Late 30s • Lead • Deputy U.S. Marshal

Controlled, guilt-driven, carrying a nine-year-old failure she has never spoken about. The role asks for physical authority and a slow unraveling underneath it.

SUGGESTED: Tika Sumpter • Nicole Beharie • Demetria McKinney

MONIQUE CARTER

38 • Lead • Federal witness

A woman who has spent two years choosing money over truth and finally runs out of road. Needs to land both the guardedness and the audience's sympathy in the same scene.

SUGGESTED: Aunjanue Ellis-Taylor • Robin Givens • Denise Boutte

SIMONE REED

29 • Lead • Hired to kill Monique

Sharp, composed, running on a decade of unprocessed grief for her sister. The part turns on one scene where the composure finally breaks.

SUGGESTED: KiKi Layne • Reagan Gomez • Erica Peeples

KENDRA VALE

44 • Lead • Crisis counselor / contract operative

Soft-spoken, precise, the most dangerous person in every room she is in. The part is a masterclass in menace played almost entirely without raising her voice.

SUGGESTED: Sanaa Lathan • Tasha Smith • Vanessa Bell Calloway

RENEE (SUPPORTING)

Early 30s • Patricia's daughter, the bride

The emotional stakes waiting on the other end of the phone. Needs warmth and backbone in a handful of scenes.

SUGGESTED: Simone Missick • KJ Smith

GRANGER (SUPPORTING)

50s • Federal supervisor

Brief but pivotal. Delivers the film's harshest verdict on Diana with total control.

SUGGESTED: Delroy Lindo • Michael Beach

All casting suggestions are aspirational, for packaging and pitch purposes only. None are attached or confirmed.